



Cloud Desktops to take over?

On a PC, a full Windows desktop-as-a-service is now available to replace your existing Windows desktop. <https://dgit.in/july21-112>



Discord AI to prevent harassment

Discord has purchased Sentropy, a company working on AI tools to detect harassment online. <https://dgit.in/july21-113>

Graphics card prices have begun to fall

Crypto crackdown crashes prices

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irst came the global pandemic which brought major economies to a standstill and then

we had the crypto surge of 2021. The first event hit silicon manufacturing pipelines along with graphics card manufacturers in Shenzhen and other parts of China. There were no graphics cards or other components being produced at many of the factories owned by major manufacturers. And as multiple countries initiated lockdown protocols, people had to start working from home and there was a sudden surge in demand for laptops and desktop PCs, and everything that goes in them.

What we saw was a drop in manufacturing numbers and a surge in demand for the same. This widened the supply-demand gap like nothing has so far since silicon was used to make transistors. And later came the cryptocurrency surge which made virtual currencies such as Bitcoin and ethereum jump up in value and made it viable to be mined on graphics cards. Miners across the world started buying graphics cards in bulk from distributors and even brands directly. And brands were more than happy to sell miners cards originally meant for gamers. They are a business at the end of the day and all they're concerned about

is selling graphics cards. It doesn't matter who buys the cards as long as the cards get sold.

Companies such as NVIDIA came out with drivers that crippled mining rates and even released a new line-up of 'CMP' cards meant for miners so that gamers could get their hands on a few GPUs. NVIDIA has even crippled hash rates on their newer LHR GPUs so that even if miners find a

in EU markets. So an RTX 3090 which was selling for USD 1499 could actually be seen selling for approximately USD 4500. You could build three decent 1080p gaming machines in that amount. As the situation started to seem utterly bleak, gamers around the world found an unlikely saviour in the PRC Govt.

You see mining cryptocurrencies, at least the more popular ones,



loophole in the crippled drivers, they still wouldn't find it feasible to mine on LHR cards. At least NVIDIA tried, AMD did nothing of that sort.

All of this sent graphics card prices skyrocketing. In May 2021, they hit their absolute peak at 304%

costs a lot of electricity. And miners in China were consuming copious amounts of it. A large mining facility's consumption was enough to starve neighbouring buildings, factories and whole towns of their electricity pool. China alone contributed